

Technology-driven social determinants of health screening for patients with neurological conditions



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Background

- Social determinants of health (SDOH) are the conditions in which individuals are born, grow, work, live, and age, contributing to approximately 50% of health outcomes.¹⁻²
- Health-related social needs (HRSNs) represent individual-level barriers that directly impact a patient's ability to access and engage in healthcare. By leveraging technology to integrate screening tools into pharmacy workflows, pharmacists can systematically assess patients' HRSN and improve care coordination.¹⁻²

Objective

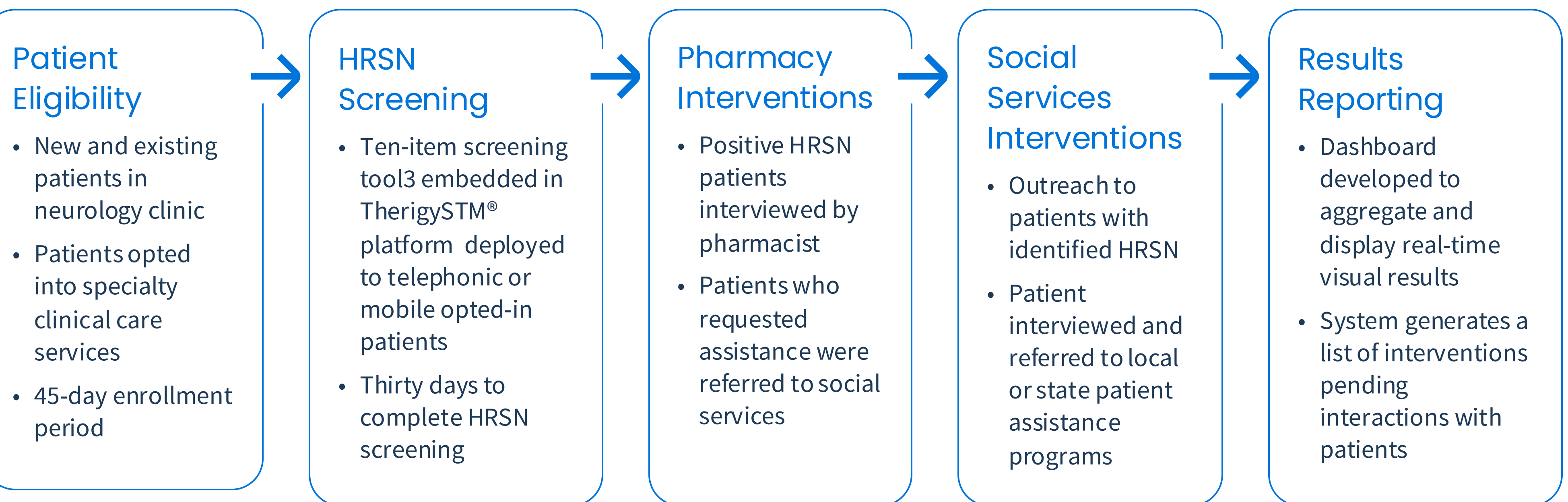
To Streamline:

- 1 HRSN identification
- 2 SDOH data visualization using technology-driven approach
- 3 Referral process to social work and patient assistance resources

within a health-system specialty pharmacy

Description

In November 2024 , an HSSP launched a pilot to screen³ for HRSN in adult patients with neurological disorders.

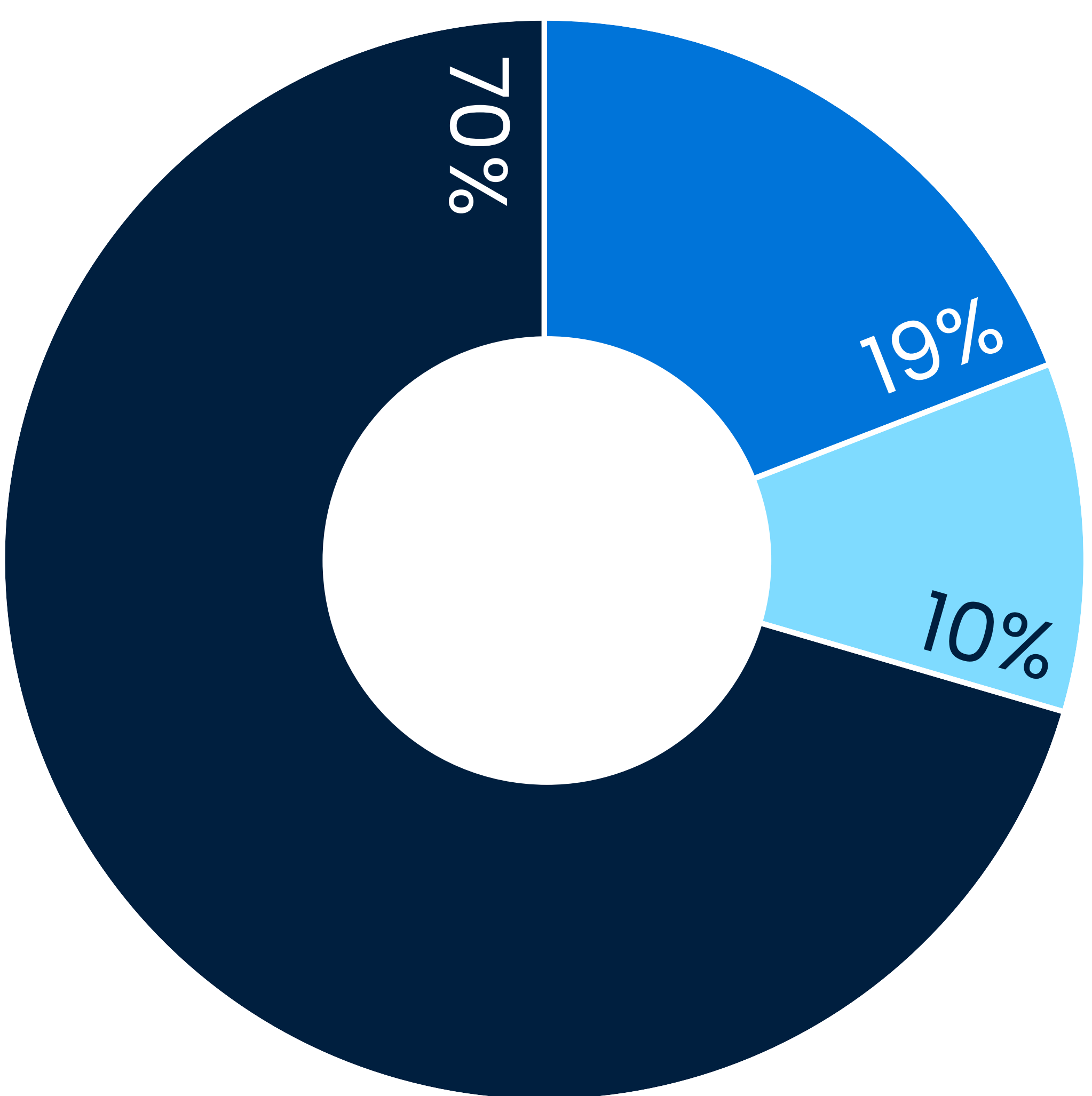


Evaluation

Figure 1: Patients' HRSN screening results

N = 115

- HRSN POSITIVE, REQUESTED ASSISTANCE
- HRSN POSITIVE, DECLINED ASSISTANCE
- HRSN NEGATIVE



10%

of patients with unmet HRSN(s) declined connection to resources because they had access to personal resources.

19%

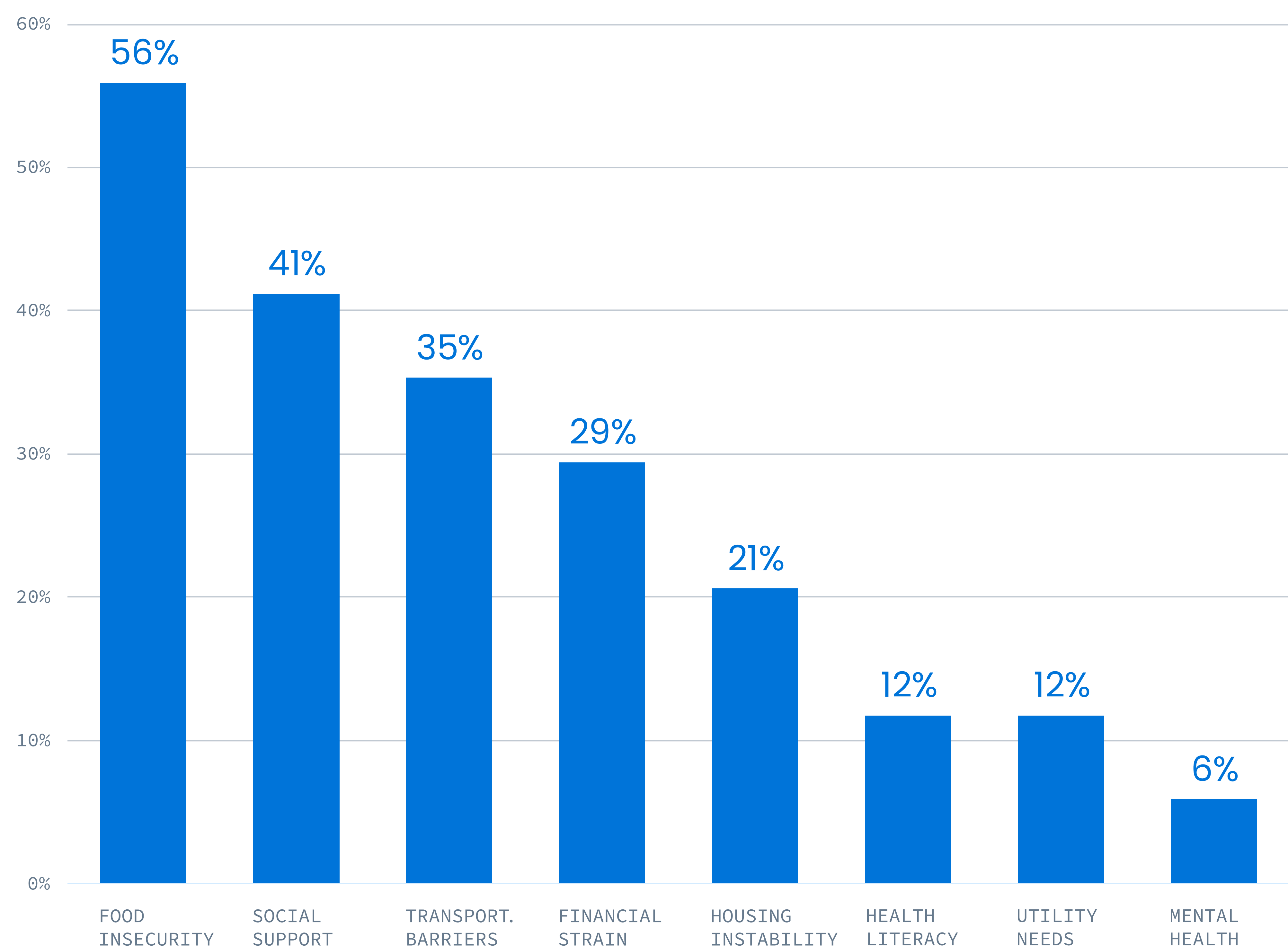
of patients who reported one or up to six unmet HRSN(s) and requested assistance were successfully referred to the health system's social services.

Discussion & Conclusion

- This pilot demonstrates the operational advantages of technology-driven processes through proactive identification of HRSNs and increased utilization of social services.
- HSSP teams effectively identified HRSNs and referred patients to social services, highlighting how specialty pharmacists can leverage their unique placement within the health system to assess HRSNs and improve care coordination.
- Data visualization also provided consistency in screening and referral services and enabled the health system to evaluate the population's needs in addressing barriers for SDOH.

Figure 2: Patients with neurological conditions who reported unmet HRSNs

N = 34



References

- ¹ Social determinants of health. World Health Organization. May 30, 2019. Accessed July 14, 2025. <https://www.who.int/health-topics/social-determinants-of-health>
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- ³ Health Leads. Social needs screening toolkit. Updated May 2023. Accessed July 14, 2025. https://nursing.utexas.edu/sites/default/files/AMEN_Health_Leads_Social_Needs_Screening_Toolkit.pdf